
LEADERSHIP, THEORIES AND TYPES OF LEADERSHIP

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ABSTRACT

Here's a abstract for a research paper on the leadership, theories and types of leadership. Numerous explanations, classifications, theories, types and definitions about leadership, exist in the contemporary literature. Sustainable effort has gone in to classify different dimensions of active leadership thus, generating considerable organizational and social research of leadership styles and behaviors. Many researchers and practitioners have developed a consensus that the progression of thinking over the years has developed a belief that leadership is a flexible developmental process, with each new piece of research building on and seldom completely disregarding that which was derived before it. Main theories that emerged during 20th century include: the Great man theory, Trait theory, Process leadership theory, style and behavioural theory. Types are Transformational theory, Transactional and laissez faire leadership theory.

Keywords: Organization, Leadership, Theories, Principles, Methods, Management, Education And Practices.

I. INTRODUCTION

Every company, no matter what industry they are a part of or how big they are, needs good leadership to be successful. Good leaders are a vital part of effective business practices. And for most, being a good leader doesn't come inherently. That's why there are entire degree programs dedicated to management and helping students become great leaders in their business. Good leaders are thus made, not born. Good leadership is developed through ending process of self-study, education, training, and the accumulation of relevant experience. The types of leadership applied in functions entailing very high degree of precision, confidence level, sensitivity, care and technical expertise may be different than in simple management-oriented portfolios, as one that does not fit all heads. It means that situations, contexts, culture, working environment, new laws and regulations, information overload, organizational complexities and psycho-socio developments remarkably impact the leadership concept thereby, making it commensurate to the changing organizational dynamics (Amabile, Schatzel, Moneta and Kramer, 2004).

The great men became irrelevant and consequently growth of the organizations. "The passing years have given the coup de grace to another force the great man who with brilliance and farsightedness could preside with dictatorial powers as the head of a growing organization but in the process retarded democratization". It was also determined that, "a person does not become a leader merely by virtue of the possession of some combinations of traits" (Samad, 2012). On the amount of direction and guidance, the dynamic among these factors was established; socio-emotional support and task behavior, in performing a task the readiness level (commitment and competence) of the followers and relationship behavior required by the followers functions and objective (Ryan and Tipu, 2013). Without involving subordinates make the decisions and hence takes no real leadership role other than assuming the positions and the democratic leader accesses his subordinates then takes his decision. Leadership literature reveals that theories have been refined and modified with passage of time and none of the theory is completely irrelevant. As mentioned earlier, relevance depends on the context in that it is supplied.

Leadership involves a type of responsibility aimed at achieving particular ends by applying the available resources (human and material) and ensuring a cohesive and coherent organization in the process (Parker, 2013). Rowe (2007) described leadership as a process whereby an individual influences a group of individuals to achieve a common goal. This article contends that effective leadership is crucial to the proper operation and very survival of a non-profit organization.

II. THEORIES OF LEADERSHIP

1. Great Man Theory:

Have you ever heard the phrase, “Great leaders are born, not made”? This quote sums up the basic tenet of the great man theory of leadership, which suggests that leadership capacity is innate. According to this theory, you are either a natural-born leader or not. The term “great man” was used because, at the time, leadership was thought of primarily as a male quality, especially in terms of military leadership. In many examples, it seems as if the right man for the job seems to emerge almost magically to take control of a situation and lead a group of people into safety or success. Historian Thomas Carlyle also had a major influence on this theory of leadership. He stated, “The history of the world is but the biography of great men”. He proposed that the eventful man remained complex in a historic situation, but did not really determine the course. On the other hand, he maintained that the actions of the event-making man influenced the course of events, which could have been much different, had he not been involved in the process. The event making man’s role based on “the consequences of outstanding capacities of intelligence, will and character rather than the actions of distinction”. Some of the earliest research of leadership looked at people who were already successful leaders. These individuals often included aristocratic rules who achieved their position through birthright. Because people of a lesser social status had fewer opportunities to practice and achieve leadership roles, it contributed to the idea that leadership is an inherent ability.

2. Trait theory:

Over the last few centuries, historians, social philosophers, and theorists, have described and modified leadership theories. These postulations have come a long way with the trait theory of leadership, with no single definition of what effective leadership is: The trait theory of leadership refers to the approach where leaders have certain qualities or a set of traits. These are specific behavioural patterns that differentiate leaders from followers. The trait theory of leadership considers a few broad characteristics- mental, social and physical. The combination of these is what makes an effective leader. It is the essential to note the top contributors to this trait theory. Some scholars studied personalities, while other looked at it from an organisational perspective. Notable names include Gordon Allport, Ralph Melvin Stogdill, Timothy Judge, Joyce Bono, and Stephen Zaccaro. Their studies on traits and leadership spanned between the 1930s to the early 2000s. This theory and its later modifications became more systematic over the years and could finally debunk Carlyle’s proposition. The trait theories create the standard for organizations to evaluate the leader’s commonly benchmarked interpersonal skills. The trait perspective of personality of an individual and the number of traits they have. An example of a trait perspective would be an extroverted person who seeks gratification from human interaction.

3. Process leadership theory:

Process leadership is a leadership style that prioritizes the management, optimization, and continuous improvement of internal processes within an organization. It revolves around the strategic oversight of organizational processes, aiming to enhance efficiency, productivity, and overall performance. Unlike traditional leadership models that primarily focus on people and tasks, process leadership concentrates on the methods, systems, and workflows that drive an organization. Enhanced efficiency and productivity of leadership involves analyzing existing processes, identifying bottlenecks, and implementing improvements. By streamlining workflows and eliminating wastes, organizations can significantly enhance their efficiency and productivity. This optimization allows employees to work more effectively, leading to higher output and better results. When employees understand that their suggestions for process improvement are valued, it boosts their morale and engagement levels. This freedom to innovate not only motivates employees and pride to their work, which can translate into a shared commitment to the organization’s goals, fostering a culture of collaboration and dedication.

Process leadership equips organizations with the tools to adapt quickly. Leaders who understand and optimize their processes can respond efficiently to market fluctuations, emerging technologies, and evolving customer demands. They create a culture of adaptability, where employees are guided through changes, ensuring that they not only understand the technology but also use it to its full potential. Process leadership is not merely a managerial approach; it is a mindset that permeates an entire organization. In a world where change is constant

and competition is fierce, embracing process leadership is not just an option- it is a necessity for any organization striving to thrive in the 21st century.

4. Style and behavioural theory:

The behavioural leadership theory focuses on how leaders behave, and assumes that these traits can be copied by other leaders. Sometimes called the style theory, it suggests that leaders aren't born successful, but can be created based on learnable behaviour. Behavioural theories of leadership focus heavily on the actions of a leader- this theory suggests that the best predictor of leadership success is viewing how a leader acts. Action rather than qualities are the focal points of behavioural learning theory. Patterns of behaviour are observed and categorized as "styles of leadership" in this theory. Some of the styles of leadership include task-oriented leaders, people-oriented leaders, country club leaders, status-quo leaders, dictatorial leaders, and more. At the end of the day, the actions and actual behaviours of a leader are what defines success in this theory. Whatever behaviour you choose, the behavioural leadership theory helps leaders focus on their actions and utilize their decisions to be a great leader.

III. TYPES OF LEADERSHIP

1. Transformational theory:

Transformational leadership is a leadership style that focuses on inspiring and motivating followers to achieve their full potential and exceed their own expectations. This theory was first introduced by James MacGregor Burns in 1978 and later expanded upon by Bernard M. Bass in the 1980s. It has since gained widespread recognition and is widely applied in various organizations, ranging from business and education to healthcare and government. Transformational leaders grade their relationships with followers very high in priority and demonstrate individualized considerations in meeting their needs for empowerment, achievement, enhanced self-efficacy and personal growth. Leadership styles, however, do not embrace all of the factors that influence innovation.

At the core of transformational leadership are four key components:

- **Idealized Influence:** Transformational leaders serve as role models for their followers. They lead by example, displaying high ethical standards, integrity, and a strong commitment to their values and vision. By embodying the ideals they promote, leaders earn the trust and respect of their teams, which fosters a sense of loyalty and admiration.
- **Inspirational Motivation:** transformational leaders have the ability to articulate a compelling vision of the future. They inspire and motivate their teams by painting a vivid picture of what success looks like and how each team member contributes to achieving that vision. This motivation goes beyond monetary incentives; it taps into the intrinsic motivation of individuals.
- **Intellectual stimulations:** Transformational leaders encourage creativity and innovation within their teams. They challenge the status quo, promote critical thinking, and create an environment where team members feel safe to voice their ideas and opinions. This intellectual stimulation leads to the generation of new ideas and solutions.
- **Individualized considerations:** Transformational leaders take a genuine interest in the personal and professional development of each team member. They recognize the unique strengths and weaknesses of their team members and provide individualized support and coaching to help them grow and excel. This personalized approach fosters a strong sense of belonging and engagement among team members.

2. Transactional theory:

Transactional leadership, also known as managerial leadership, is a leadership style where leaders rely on rewards and punishments to achieve optimal job performance from their subordinates. The transactional executive leadership model is based on an exchange or transaction. The leader rewards workers who perform their tasks to the specified levels and punishes workers who do not perform to those set standards. Their relationship between leader and subordinates is based on theories that assume individuals are not self-motivated and need structure, instructions and supervision to accomplish their jobs.

The three approaches to transactional leadership are the following:

- **Contingent reward:** Contingent reward leadership focuses on achieving results. As humans appreciate concrete, tangible, material rewards in exchange of their efforts, thus, this behaviour surfaced. "Where

transformational leadership acknowledges individual talents and builds enthusiasm through emotional appeals, values, and belief systems, transactional leadership engenders compliance by appealing to the wants and needs of individuals”.

- **Management by exception(active):** management by exception is not the relinquishment of leadership, characterized by a laissez-faire leadership. Leaders who follow management by exception have an inherent trust in their workers to end the job to a satisfactory standard, and avoid rocking the boat. “This type of leadership does not inspire workers to achieve beyond expected outcomes.
- **Management by exception(passive):** It is the style of transactional leadership in which the leaders avoid specifying agreement, and fail to provide goals and standards to be achieved by staff. Sometimes, a leader waits for things to go wrong before taking actions.

3. Laissez-faire leadership:

Laissez-faire leadership is most effective when the people you’re leading have the ability to do their job well. Group members should be resourceful, dependable, ambitious, and confident in their abilities. While no one is perfect and mistakes are inevitable, this leadership style is a great fit for highly skilled experts that require little to no oversight. In addition to team member- specific requirements, the laissez-faire leadership style may also be beneficial to apply in certain situations. In projects or fields of work where your team needs to be creative, micromanaging can stifle this- a laissez-faire approach works best here. Industries where laissez-faire leadership is most effective include advertising, entertainment, technology, and retail buying. Laissez-faire leaders allow their followers to have the autonomy to make their own decisions and manage their own desks.

IV. CONCLUSION

Advocates of transformational leadership have confidence in that the arrangements of the past should not be the guide for the future. They believe that successful transformational leaders create clear and compelling visions for the future. The transformational leaders focus their energies on vision, long-term goals, aligning and changing systems and developing and training others, bass purports that such leaders show transactional behaviours as well. He opined that great men were born, not made. However, subsequent events unfolded that this concept of leadership was morally flawed, as was the case with Hitler, Napoleon, and the like, thereby challenging the credibility of the great man theory. This initial focus on intellectual, physical, and personality traits the distinguished non-leaders from leaders portended a research that maintained that only minor variances exist between followers and leaders. Effective educational leadership style in university management is relatively fast, easy and cost effective if applied approximately. The results of the effective educational leadership style applications are feasible for a number of purposes, which include improve administrative performance, team-building, and enhanced individual and university innovation in teaching and learning.

V. REFERENCE

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